

SSC CGL Study Notes: The Ultimate Deep Dive

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Topics covered: Quantitative Aptitude (Percentage) · Reasoning (Analogy) · English Language (One-Word Substitution) · General Awareness (Modern Indian History)

QUANTITATIVE APTITUDE: PERCENTAGE

1. The Absolute Foundation

Etymology: “Per Cent” means *per hundred* or *for every hundred*.

Mathematical Meaning: A percentage is a fraction whose denominator is always 100.

The Primary Rule: To convert any number into a percentage, multiply it by 100. To convert a percentage back into a number, divide it by 100.

$$X\% = X / 100$$

$$X / Y = (X / Y \times 100)\%$$

2. The “Holy Grail” Fraction-to-Percentage Table (Must Memorize)

If you memorize this table, you will solve 60% of your percentage questions mentally without using a pen.

Fraction	Percentage	Fraction	Percentage	Fraction	Percentage
1/1	100%	1/6	16.66%	1/11	9.09%
1/2	50%	1/7	14.28%	1/12	8.33%
1/3	33.33%	1/8	12.5%	1/13	7.69%
1/4	25%	1/9	11.11%	1/14	7.14%
1/5	20%	1/10	10%	1/15	6.66%

Extension for complex fractions:

- If you know $1/12 = 8.33\%$, then $5/12 = 5 \times 8.33 = \mathbf{41.66\%}$.
- If you know $1/7 = 14.28\%$, then $3/7 = \mathbf{42.85\%}$.

3. The Three Cardinal Types of Percentage Problems

Every SSC question falls into one of these three mathematical structures:

Type A (Find the Part): What is $X\%$ of N ? → Formula: $(X / 100) \times N$

Ex: What is 35% of 200? → $(35 / 100) \times 200 = 70$.

Type B (Find the Percent): What percent is A of B ? → Formula: $(A / B) \times 100$

Ex: 75 is what percent of 300? $\rightarrow (75 / 300) \times 100 = 25\%$.

Type C (Find the Whole): If X% of a number is Y, find the number. $\rightarrow$ Formula: $(Y / X) \times 100$

Ex: If 40% of a number is 240, find the number. $\rightarrow (240 / 40) \times 100 = 600$.

4. Percentage Increase / Decrease (The Change Formula)

This is the most heavily tested concept in SSC CGL.

- **Absolute Change:** Final Value (FV) – Initial Value (IV)
- **Percentage Increase:** $((FV - IV) / IV) \times 100$ (When $FV > IV$)
- **Percentage Decrease:** $((IV - FV) / IV) \times 100$ (When $IV > FV$)

The “Price-Consumption-Expenditure” Master Concept

Rule: Expenditure = Price $\times$ Consumption. If Expenditure is constant (fixed), then Price and Consumption are inversely proportional.

- If Price increases by P%, then Consumption must **decrease** by: $(P / (100 + P)) \times 100$
- If Price decreases by P%, then Consumption must **increase** by: $(P / (100 - P)) \times 100$

SSC Level Example: If the price of rice increases by 20%, by how much percent must a family reduce its consumption so that the total expenditure remains the same?

$\rightarrow$ Apply: $(20 / (100 + 20)) \times 100 = (20 / 120) \times 100 = 16.66\%$ (Answer).

5. Successive Percentage Change (The Game Changer)

Whenever a number is changed by two or more percentages one after another, **NEVER add or subtract the percentages directly.**

Formula for two successive changes of a% and b%:

$$\text{Net \% Change} = a + b + (a \times b / 100)$$

(Note: Use + for increase and – for decrease)

Trick to remember: If the final result is positive $\rightarrow$ Net Increase. If negative $\rightarrow$ Net Decrease.

SSC Level Example: A shopkeeper increases the price of an item by 10% and then gives a discount of 10%. What is the net percentage change in the price?

$\rightarrow$ Apply: $10 + (-10) + ((10 \times -10) / 100) = 0 - 1 = -1\%$.

(Conclusion: Even though it looks like no change, there is ALWAYS a net loss of $x^2/100$ % when a number is increased and decreased by the same x%).

6. “A is What Percent More/Less Than B” (The Comparison Trap)

This is the #1 trap area in SSC. The denominator changes based on what comes after the word “than”.

Golden Rule:

- If it says “A is P% more than B”, then **B is your denominator** (100%).
- If it says “B is P% less than A”, then **A is your denominator** (100%).

Derived Shortcuts (Memorize these to save 2 minutes):

- If A is P% more than B, then B is less than A by: $(P / (100 + P)) \times 100$
- If A is P% less than B, then B is more than A by: $(P / (100 - P)) \times 100$

SSC Level Example: Ram's salary is 25% more than Shyam's salary. Shyam's salary is what percent less than Ram's?

→ Here P = 25. Since Ram is MORE than Shyam, Shyam is LESS than Ram by: $(25 / (100 + 25)) \times 100 = (25 / 125) \times 100 = 20\%$.

7. The Concept of "Multiplying Factor" (For Population, Machines, and Voters)

Instead of doing lengthy additions, multiply the original number by a factor.

- If value increases by R% → Multiply it by $(100 + R) / 100$
- If value decreases by R% → Multiply it by $(100 - R) / 100$

SSC Level Example: In a city, the population increased by 15% in 2025. If the population in 2024 was 40,000, what is the population in 2025?

→ Do not do 15% of 40,000 + 40,000. Use factor: $40000 \times (115 / 100) = 40000 \times 1.15 = 46,000$.

For multiple years (Successive with factor): If population is 50,000, increases 10% in Year 1 and decreases 8% in Year 2:

→ Final = $50000 \times (110/100) \times (92/100) = 50000 \times 1.1 \times 0.92 = 50,600$.

8. The Voter / Election Problems (Special SSC Module)

In elections, there are usually valid votes, invalid votes, and the winning margin.

Standard Structure:

1. Total Voters = Valid Votes + Invalid Votes.
2. Winner gets P% of valid votes, Loser gets Q% of valid votes.
3. Winning Margin = $(P - Q)\%$ of Valid Votes.

SSC Level Example: In an election, 10% of the voters on the voter list did not vote. 10% of the votes cast were declared invalid. The winning candidate got 60% of the valid votes and won by 2,43,000 votes. Find the number of voters on the voter list.

Solution (Step-by-step):

- Let total voters on the list = 100.
- Voters who did not vote = 10% → Casted votes = 90.
- Invalid votes = 10% of 90 = 9 → Valid votes = $90 - 9 = 81$.
- Winner got 60% of 81 = 48.6. Loser got 40% of 81 = 32.4.
- Winning Margin = $48.6 - 32.4 = 16.2$.
- The question says actual winning margin is 2,43,000.
- So, 16.2 units = 2,43,000.
- 1 unit = $2,43,000 / 16.2 = 15,000$.
- Therefore, Total voters (100 units) = $15,000 \times 100 = 15,00,000$.

9. Miscellaneous High-Level SSC Tricks

- If a number is first increased by P% and then decreased by Q% (or vice versa): You can solve by the successive formula. Remember, multiplication is commutative, so the order (increase then decrease OR decrease then increase) does not change the final result.
- Income = Expenditure + Saving. If Income increases by X%, Expenditure increases by Y%, then the percentage change in Saving is found by assuming Income = 100 and Expenditure = 80 (or any convenient number) at the start.

Examination Marks / Passing Marks:

- If a student gets P marks and fails by X marks $\rightarrow$ Passing Marks = P + X.
- If a student gets Q marks and gets Y marks more than passing $\rightarrow$ Passing Marks = Q - Y.
- To find total maximum marks, equate the passing percentage.

Example: A student gets 40% marks and fails by 30 marks. Another student gets 60% marks and gets 20 marks more than passing. Find the maximum marks.

Let Max Marks = M. Passing Marks = 40% of M + 30 = 60% of M - 20.

$\rightarrow 0.4M + 30 = 0.6M - 20 \rightarrow 50 = 0.2M \rightarrow \mathbf{M = 250}.$

10. The Fresh Fruit / Dry Fruit Problem

This is a very famous SSC CGL trick question.

Rule: In fresh fruit, the percentage of water is given, and the rest is the solid (pulp). When the fruit dries, only the water evaporates; the solid (pulp) remains constant.

Example: Fresh grapes contain 80% water. Dry grapes contain 25% water. If 100 kg of fresh grapes are dried, how many kg of dry grapes will be obtained?

Solution:

- Fresh grapes: Water = 80%, Solid = 20%. Solid in 100 kg = 20 kg.
- Dry grapes: Water = 25%, which means Solid = 75%.
- The 20 kg of solid in fresh grapes will become 75% of the dry grapes.
- Let dry grapes be D kg.
- $75\% \text{ of } D = 20 \rightarrow (75/100) \times D = 20 \rightarrow D = (20 \times 100) / 75 = \mathbf{26.66 \text{ kg}}.$

Final Pro-Tip for QA: For the next 2 hours, do not move to any other subject. Take 20 random percentage questions from your mock test series. Before solving, write down whether it is Type A, B, C, Price-Consumption, Successive, or Voter-based. This categorization alone will boost your accuracy to 90%.

REASONING & GENERAL INTELLIGENCE: ANALOGY

Analogy is the highest-scoring, lowest-effort topic in SSC CGL Tier 1. The rule is simple: **Find the exact relationship in the first pair and apply the SAME relationship to the second pair.**

In SSC CGL, Analogies are asked in 3 forms: **Word (Semantic)**, **Number (Mathematical)**, and **Figural (Image)**. All are covered in microscopic detail below.

1. Semantic (Word) Analogy - The “Meaning” Game

Here, you need a strong vocabulary and the ability to see how two words are connected logically.

A. Standard Relationships (With SSC Examples)

Synonym (Same Meaning): Example: Abode : Dwelling :: Confess : ? (Answer: Admit). Trick: If both words mean the same thing, find the same in the options.

Antonym (Opposite Meaning): Example: Ephemeral : Permanent :: Naive : ? (Answer: Cunning). Trick: Look for the exact opposite degree.

Degree of Intensity (One is a weaker/milder version of the other): Example: Angry : Furious :: Happy : ? (Answer: Ecstatic). (Here, Furious is an intense form of Angry; Ecstatic is the intense form of Happy).

Worker & Tool (Person uses this object): Example: Doctor : Stethoscope :: Carpenter : ? (Answer: Saw).

Worker & Product (Person creates this): Example: Poet : Poem :: Architect : ? (Answer: Design/Building).

Part to Whole (One is a component of the other): Example: Wheel : Car :: Branch : ? (Answer: Tree).

Individual to Group (One is a member of a collective): Example: Flower : Bouquet :: Singer : ? (Answer: Choir).

Material to Product (Raw material to finished good): Example: Wood : Furniture :: Clay : ? (Answer: Pot).

Cause and Effect: Example: Rain : Flood :: Overeating : ? (Answer: Obesity).

Gender (Masculine to Feminine or Young ones): Example: Bulls : Cows :: Stallion : ? (Answer: Mare). Young one example: Dog : Puppy :: Cat : ? (Answer: Kitten).

B. The “Reverse Analogy” Trap (Very Common in SSC)

Sometimes, the relationship is not First : Second. It could be Second : First, or even interchanged.

Example: Virus : Ebola :: Bacteria : ? Here, Ebola is a type of Virus. So the answer will be a type of Bacteria (e.g., Streptococcus). Always form a sentence: “Ebola is a type of Virus.” Then apply: “_____ is a type of Bacteria.”

2. Number (Mathematical) Analogy - The “Calculation” Game

This is the most scoring part of Analogy. You have to find the hidden mathematical operation. In SSC, the operations can be on individual digits or on the whole number.

A. Operations on the Whole Number (Direct Math)

Direct Square/Cube: Example: 3 : 9 :: 4 : ? (Answer: 16, because $3^2 = 9$, so $4^2 = 16$).

Square with Addition/Subtraction: Example: 5 : 24 :: 7 : ? (Answer: 48, because $5^2 - 1 = 24$, so $7^2 - 1 = 48$).

Cube with Addition/Subtraction: Example: 6 : 215 :: 4 : ? (Answer: 63, because $6^3 - 1 = 215$, so $4^3 - 1 = 63$).

Multiplication with a fixed multiplier: Example: 8 : 56 :: 9 : ? (Answer: 63, because $8 \times 7 = 56$, so $9 \times 7 = 63$).

Addition/Subtraction with a fixed difference: Example: 24 : 52 :: 19 : ? (Answer: 47, because $24 + 28 = 52$, so $19 + 28 = 47$).

B. Operations on Individual Digits (The “Split” Method — Very Important for SSC)

If the numbers are 2 or 3 digits, break them down and apply operations on the digits.

Sum of Digits: Example: 82 : 10 :: 64 : ? (Answer: 10, because $8+2=10$, so $6+4=10$).

Product of Digits: Example: 23 : 6 :: 41 : ? (Answer: 4, because $2 \times 3=6$, so $4 \times 1=4$).

Difference of Squares of Digits: Example: 82 : 60 :: 73 : ? (Answer: 40, because $8^2 - 2^2 = 64 - 4 = 60$, so $7^2 - 3^2 = 49 - 9 = 40$).

Combination (Product + Sum): Example: 34 : 19 :: 25 : ? (Answer: 17, because $(3 \times 4) + (3+4) = 12+7 = 19$. So for 25: $(2 \times 5) + (2+5) = 10+7 = 17$).

C. The “Double Analogy” or “SSC Special” (Three numbers in a bracket)

Sometimes, SSC gives a set of 3 numbers like (3, 15, 24) :: (4, 20, ?). Here, you must find how the 1st relates to the 2nd, and the 2nd relates to the 3rd.

Example: (3, 15, 24) :: (4, 20, ?)

- 1st → 2nd: $3 \times 5 = 15$.
- 2nd → 3rd: $15 + 9 = 24$.
- Apply same to 4: $4 \times 5 = 20$; and $20 + 9 = \mathbf{29}$ (Answer).

Another pattern (Square/Cube combo): $(3, 9, 27) :: (4, 16, ?)$

- $3 \rightarrow 9 (3^2)$, $9 \rightarrow 27 (9 \times 3)$. Apply: $4^2 = 16$, $16 \times 4 = \mathbf{64}$ (Answer).

3. Figural (Image) Analogy - The “Visual” Game

In Tier 1, SSC shows a figure on the left and asks you to find the missing figure on the right. You must analyze the changes in shapes, lines, shading, and positions.

A. Common Figural Changes

Rotation (Clockwise / Anti-clockwise): The 1st figure rotates by 45° , 90° , or 180° to become the 2nd figure. Apply the exact same angle of rotation to the 3rd figure to get the 4th. *Example:* If a triangle pointing up becomes a triangle pointing right (90° clockwise), then a square pointing up must become a square pointing right.

Reflection (Mirror Image / Water Image): The 1st and 2nd figures are mirror images of each other. Apply the same mirror line (horizontal/vertical) to the 3rd figure.

Increase/Decrease in Components: The 1st figure has 3 lines, the 2nd has 5 lines (increase by +2). Apply +2 to the 3rd figure to get the answer. Or: The 1st figure has 4 small circles inside a box, the 2nd has 3 (decrease by -1). Apply -1 to the 3rd.

Shifting of Elements: The shaded part inside a square moves from the top-left corner to the bottom-right corner. Apply the same positional shift to the elements in the 3rd figure.

Addition of Elements: The 1st figure + 2nd figure = 3rd figure (overlapping or merging). You have to find the 4th figure based on similar addition.

4. The “Zero Error” Method to Solve Any Analogy in 10 Seconds

Follow this step-by-step mental process to never get an analogy wrong:

1. Form a precise sentence between the 1st and 2nd terms. *Example: For “Doctor : Stethoscope”, your sentence is: “A Doctor uses a Stethoscope to treat patients.”*
2. Apply this exact sentence to the 3rd term. So, “A _____ uses a _____ to treat patients.”
3. Scan the options and see which one fits perfectly in the blanks.
4. If two options fit, find a secondary relationship. *Check for: Is it singular/plural? Is there a specific gender? Is it a specific material? The second-level relationship will always eliminate the wrong one.*

5. The “VIBGYOR” Trick for Letter Analogies (Extra Edge)

If the analogy has letters (e.g., ACEG : BDFH :: ZXVT : ?), always count the positional values (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26).

Example: ACEG : BDFH

- A(1) → B(2) [+1], C(3) → D(4) [+1], E(5) → F(6) [+1], G(7) → H(8) [+1].
- Apply same to ZXVT: Z(26) → A(1) [+1, wrap around], X(24) → Y(25) [+1], V(22) → W(23) [+1], T(20) → U(21) [+1].
- **Answer: AYWU.**

Final Pro-Tip for Reasoning: In your mock test, solve all Analogy questions first. They take 10-15 seconds each and guarantee 100% accuracy. Never overthink an analogy. If you find a complex relationship that takes more than 30 seconds, eliminate the 2 obvious wrong options and make a calculated guess between the remaining two.



ENGLISH LANGUAGE: ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION

One-Word Substitution tests your ability to replace a long phrase or a group of words with a single, precise word. In SSC CGL, this topic carries 3-5 marks and is highly scoring if you know the right words.

1. The Core Strategy for SSC CGL

- **Learn Thematically:** Group words by categories (People, Places, Professions, Fears, Government, etc.). This helps in better recall.
- **Focus on Roots & Prefixes:** Understanding Latin/Greek roots can help you guess the meaning of unfamiliar words.
- **Practice PYQs (Previous Year Questions):** SSC repeats many words across shifts. Make a list of all one-word substitutions from the last 5 years.

2. Master List Categorized for SSC CGL

A. Terms Related to People (Based on Character/Behaviour)

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
A person who loves mankind and works for its welfare	Philanthropist
A person who hates mankind	Misanthrope
A person who loves women	Philogynist
A person who hates women	Misogynist
A person who looks at the bright side of things	Optimist
A person who looks at the dark side of things	Pessimist
A person who is selflessly concerned for the welfare of others	Altruist
A person who thinks only of himself	Egoist / Egocentric
A person who is present everywhere	Omnipresent
A person who knows everything	Omniscient
A person who is all-powerful	Omnipotent
A person who is fluent in many languages	Polyglot
A person who can use both hands equally well	Ambidextrous
A person who is easily deceived or cheated	Gullible
A person who is unable to pay his debts	Insolvent / Bankrupt
A person who is overly concerned with minor details	Pedant
A person who does not believe in the existence of God	Atheist
A person who believes in the existence of God	Theist
A person who is unsure about God's existence	Agnostic
A person who is a habitual drinker of alcohol	Alcoholic / Inebriate
A person who is a habitual smoker	Chain-smoker
A person who is a wanderer / has no fixed home	Vagabond / Nomad

B. Terms Related to Professions / Occupations

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
One who studies the past through remains and artifacts	Archaeologist
One who studies the origin and history of words	Etymologist
One who studies the stars and planets	Astronomer
One who studies plants	Botanist
One who studies animals	Zoologist
One who studies the human mind and behavior	Psychologist
One who studies diseases and their causes	Pathologist
One who studies the functioning of the human body	Physiologist
One who writes a book about their own life	Autobiographer
One who writes a book about the life of another person	Biographer
One who edits a book or manuscript	Editor
One who compiles a dictionary	Lexicographer
One who treats diseases using drugs/medicines	Physician
One who treats diseases through surgery	Surgeon
One who treats dental problems	Dentist
One who treats eye problems	Ophthalmologist / Optician
One who treats skin problems	Dermatologist
One who treats heart problems	Cardiologist
One who treats bones and joints	Orthopedic
One who treats children's diseases	Pediatrician
One who treats mental illnesses	Psychiatrist
One who arranges/conducts funerals	Undertaker

C. Terms Related to Places / Buildings

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
A place where birds are kept	Aviary
A place where animals are kept for display	Zoo / Zoological Garden
A place where wild animals are kept in their natural habitat	Sanctuary / Reserve
A place where weapons and ammunition are stored	Arsenal
A place where coins and medals are collected/studied	Numismatics (the study itself)
A place where stamps are collected/studied	Philately (the study itself)
A place where wine is made	Brewery / Distillery
A place where dead bodies are kept temporarily	Mortuary / Morgue
A place where historical records are kept	Archives
A place where books and manuscripts are stored	Library
A place where theatrical performances are held	Auditorium / Theatre
A place where ships are built and repaired	Dockyard / Shipyard
A place where airplanes are kept	Hangar
A place where bees are kept	Apiary
A place where silk is produced	Sericulture (the process)
A place where fish are bred	Pisciculture (the process) / Fish hatchery

D. Terms Related to Government / Administration

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
Absence of any form of government	Anarchy
Rule by one person with absolute power	Autocracy / Dictatorship
Rule by the wealthy or rich class	Plutocracy
Rule by the military	Stratocracy / Military junta
Rule by the few (small group)	Oligarchy
Rule by the nobility or aristocrats	Aristocracy
Rule by the common people / by the majority	Democracy
Rule by religious leaders	Theocracy
Government of a state by its own citizens	Self-government / Autonomy
A system where all property is owned by the community	Communism
A system where trade and industry are controlled by private owners	Capitalism
A political system where the state has supreme control	Totalitarianism

E. Terms Related to Death / Killing

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
Killing of a human being	Homicide
Killing of oneself	Suicide
Killing of a king	Regicide
Killing of a father	Patricide
Killing of a mother	Matricide
Killing of a brother	Fatricide
Killing of a sister	Sororicide
Killing of a child / infant	Infanticide
Killing of one's own spouse	Mariticide (husband) / Uxoricide (wife)
Killing of a whole race / community	Genocide
Killing of a large number of people / mass killing	Massacre / Pogrom
A person who kills for political reasons	Assassin
A person who kills for pleasure / sexual gratification	Sadist / Serial killer (colloquial)

F. Terms Related to Fears (Phobias)

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
Fear of heights	Acrophobia
Fear of confined spaces	Claustrophobia
Fear of darkness	Nyctophobia
Fear of water	Hydrophobia
Fear of fire	Pyrophobia
Fear of strangers / foreigners	Xenophobia
Fear of spiders	Arachnophobia
Fear of snakes	Ophidiophobia
Fear of dogs	Cynophobia
Fear of crowds / people	Demophobia / Agoraphobia (open spaces)
Fear of pain	Algophobia
Fear of death	Thanatophobia
Fear of public speaking	Glossophobia
Fear of germs / dirt	Mysophobia

G. Terms Related to Science / Arts / Studies

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
The art of beautiful handwriting	Calligraphy
The art of dance / composing dance sequences	Choreography
The art of arranging music for instruments	Orchestration
The art of making maps	Cartography
The study of the universe / cosmos	Cosmology
The study of heredity / genes	Genetics
The study of diseases	Pathology
The study of the heart	Cardiology
The study of the brain	Neurology
The study of the immune system	Immunology
The study of the history of words	Etymology
The study of the Earth's structure	Geology
The study of the atmosphere / weather	Meteorology
The study of human races / cultures	Anthropology
The study of ancient societies / artifacts	Archaeology
The study of coins / medals	Numismatics
The study of stamps	Philately

H. Terms Related to Literary / Writing

Elaborated Phrase	One-Word Substitution
A work of literature written in the form of letters	Epistolary
A poem of fourteen lines	Sonnet
A poem mourning the death of someone	Elegy
A short witty poem or saying	Epigram
A speech made by a character alone on stage	Soliloquy
A speech made by one character to others on stage	Monologue
A conversation between two characters	Dialogue
A written attack on someone's character	Libel (written) / Slander (spoken)
A statement that is seemingly contradictory but true	Paradox
The use of exaggeration for effect	Hyperbole
The repetition of initial consonant sounds	Alliteration
A word that imitates a natural sound	Onomatopoeia

3. The “Root Word” Trick for Unknown Words

If you don't know a word, break it down using Latin/Greek roots:

Root	Meaning	Example
Philo-	Love	Philanthropist (lover of mankind)
Miso-	Hatred	Misanthrope (hater of mankind)
-cide	Killing	Regicide (killing of a king)
-logy	Study of	Psychology (study of the mind)
-mania	Obsession / Craze	Pyromania (obsession with fire)
-phobia	Fear of	Claustrophobia (fear of confined spaces)
Omni-	All	Omniscient (all-knowing)
Bene-	Good	Benefactor (one who does good)
Mal-	Bad	Malefactor (one who does bad / evil)
Poly-	Many	Polyglot (knows many languages)
Auto-	Self	Autobiography (life story written by self)
Bio-	Life	Biography (life story of another)

4. The “Elimination” Strategy in the Exam

In SSC CGL, 4 options are given. If you don’t know the exact word:

- Step 1:** Look at the phrase carefully. Identify the core action (e.g., killing, loving, studying, fearing).
- Step 2:** Eliminate options that have completely unrelated meanings.
- Step 3:** Check the roots. If the phrase is about “fear”, the answer will have a “-phobia” root. If it’s about “killing”, it will have a “-cide” root.
- Step 4:** If still confused, choose the option that is most specific and precise to the phrase.

5. Most Repeated SSC CGL One-Word Substitutions (High Yield)

Phrase	Answer
One who is unable to pay debts	Insolvent
One who is easily deceived	Gullible
One who knows many languages	Polyglot
One who uses both hands equally	Ambidextrous
One who hates mankind	Misanthrope
One who loves mankind	Philanthropist
One who is all-powerful	Omnipotent
One who is all-knowing	Omniscient
One who is present everywhere	Omnipresent
Killing of a king	Regicide
Killing of a father	Patricide
Study of the universe	Cosmology
Study of the mind	Psychology
Fear of heights	Acrophobia
Fear of confined spaces	Claustrophobia
A place where birds are kept	Aviary
A place where animals are kept	Zoo
Government by one person	Autocracy
Absence of government	Anarchy
The art of beautiful handwriting	Calligraphy

Final Pro-Tip for English: Make a physical notebook divided into these categories. Every time you see a new one-word substitution in a mock test, add it to the relevant category. Revise this notebook 2-3 times before the exam. This way, you will master 100+ words in a month.

GENERAL AWARENESS: MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

Modern Indian History is the most important among the three History sections (Ancient, Medieval, Modern) for SSC CGL. It carries the highest weightage (~50-60% of all History questions). The questions are mostly factual — dates, names, events, places, and books.

1. The Advent of Europeans in India (Pre-1757)

A. The Portuguese (First to Arrive)

- **Vasco da Gama (1498):** First European to reach India via the sea route. Landed at Calicut (Kerala).
- **Pedro Álvares Cabral (1500):** Established the first Portuguese factory in India at Cochin.
- **Albuquerque (1509-1515):** Considered the real founder of Portuguese power in India. Captured Goa (1510) from the Bijapur Sultan and made it the capital.
- **Key Contribution:** Introduced the Printing Press in India. Also introduced the Inquisition (religious persecution of

Hindus and Muslims) in Goa.

B. The Dutch (Arrived in 1602)

- Established factories at Masulipatnam, Surat, Chinsura, and Nagapattinam.
- They were primarily interested in spices and textiles.
- Declined after their defeat in the Battle of Colachel (1741) by the Travancore king Marthanda Varma.

C. The French (Arrived in 1664)

- Established the French East India Company under Colbert.
- Established their first factory at Surat and later at Pondicherry (Puducherry).
- Dupleix was the most famous French Governor. He was the first to have the ambition of building a French empire in India.
- **Carnatic Wars (1746-1763):** The French were decisively defeated by the British in the Third Carnatic War (Battle of Wandiwash, 1760), which ended French political ambitions in India. They were left with only Pondicherry, Chandernagore, Mahe, and Karaikal as trading posts.

D. The British (Arrived in 1600)

- **1600:** Queen Elizabeth I granted the charter to form the East India Company (EIC).
- **1612:** Captain Thomas Best defeated the Portuguese in the Battle of Swally, giving the EIC confidence.
- **1615:** Sir Thomas Roe (ambassador of King James I) received the Mughal Farman (royal decree) from Emperor Jahangir to establish factories at Surat, Ahmedabad, and Bombay.

2. British Expansion and Conquest (1757-1857)

A. The Battle of Plassey (1757) - The Beginning of British Rule

- **Fought between:** British East India Company (led by Robert Clive) vs. Nawab of Bengal Siraj-ud-Daulah.
- **Reason:** The British had misused their trade privileges. Siraj-ud-Daulah captured Calcutta (which led to the Black Hole Tragedy - 146 British prisoners died in a small cell).
- **The Battle:** Mir Jafar (Siraj's commander) and the richest banker of Bengal, Jagat Seth, conspired with the British and betrayed Siraj.
- **Result:** Siraj-ud-Daulah was defeated and killed. Mir Jafar was made the puppet Nawab. This battle marked the beginning of British political rule in India.

B. The Battle of Buxar (1764) - The Solid Foundation

- **Fought between:** British (led by Hector Munro) vs. Combined forces of Mir Qasim (Nawab of Bengal), Shuja-ud-Daula (Nawab of Awadh), and Shah Alam II (Mughal Emperor).
- **Result:** Decisive victory for the British.
- **Significance:** This battle gave the British the Diwani (right to collect revenue) of Bengal, Bihar, and Odisha through the Treaty of Allahabad (1765). This made the British the revenue collector and legitimized their rule.

C. British Policies of Expansion

- **Doctrine of Lapse (1848):** Introduced by Lord Dalhousie. Under this, any princely state without a biological male heir would "lapse" (merge) into British India. States annexed: Satara (1848), Jhansi (1853), Nagpur (1854), Awadh/Oudh (1856 - on charges of misrule, not by Doctrine).
- **Subsidiary Alliance (1798):** Introduced by Lord Wellesley. The ruler had to accept a British resident, pay for British troops, and could not enter into any alliance with any other power. States forced into this: Hyderabad, Mysore, Tanjore, Awadh.

3. The Revolt of 1857 (The First War of Indian Independence)

A. Causes

Type	Key Points
Political	Doctrine of Lapse, Annexation of Awadh, disrespect to Mughal Emperor, spread of British control.
Economic	Heavy taxation, destruction of Indian industries (textiles), zamindari system, poverty of peasants.
Social	Abolition of Sati (1829), Widow Remarriage Act (1856) – considered interference in Hindu religion.
Military	Enfield Rifle cartridges greased with cow and pig fat. Offended both Hindu and Muslim soldiers.
Immediate	Mangal Pandey, a soldier in Barrackpore, attacked British officers (March 1857). He was hanged. On May 10, 1857, the sepoys of Meerut rose in revolt.

B. Key Leaders and Centers

Center	Leader	British Commander who suppressed
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar (declared nominal leader)	Nicholson
Kanpur	Nana Sahib (son of Peshwa Baji Rao II)	General Havelock
Lucknow	Begum Hazrat Mahal (wife of Nawab Wajid Ali Shah)	Henry Lawrence / Colin Campbell
Jhansi	Rani Lakshmibai (died fighting in Gwalior)	Sir Hugh Rose
Bihar	Kunwar Singh (zamindar of Jagdishpur)	—
Gwalior	Tantia Tope (Tatya Tope) – Rani's ally	—

C. Consequences

- **End of Company Rule:** The East India Company was abolished. The British Crown took direct control.
- **Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1858):** She issued a proclamation promising no further annexation, religious freedom, and equal treatment of Indians.
- **Government of India Act, 1858:** The post of Secretary of State for India was created (a member of the British Cabinet).
- **Reorganisation of Army:** The ratio of British to Indian soldiers was increased. Artillery and key positions were given only to Europeans.

4. Social & Religious Reform Movements (19th Century)

These movements played a huge role in the Indian Renaissance.

Reform Movement	Founder	Key Ideas
Brahmo Samaj (1828)	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Abolition of Sati, child marriage, idol worship. Believed in one God.
Arya Samaj (1875)	Swami Dayanand Saraswati	"Go back to the Vedas". Founded in Bombay. Opposed caste discrimination and idol worship.
Ramakrishna Mission (1897)	Swami Vivekananda	Preached universal tolerance and service to humanity. Represented Hinduism at the Parliament of World Religions (Chicago, 1893).
Theosophical Society (1875)	Madame Blavatsky & Colonel Olcott	Revived ancient Indian philosophies and Vedas.
Aligarh Movement	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan	Modernized Muslim education. Founded Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College (later Aligarh Muslim University).
Prarthana Samaj (1867)	Atmaram Pandurang	Worked for social reforms in Maharashtra.
Satya Shodhak Samaj (1873)	Jyotiba Phule	Worked for the upliftment of lower castes and women.

5. The Indian National Movement (1885-1947)

A. Formation of the Indian National Congress (INC)

- Founded in 1885 by A.O. Hume (a retired British officer) with the aim of providing a platform for political dialogue.
- First Session:** Bombay (December 1885). W.C. Bonnerjee was the first President.
- Important Early Leaders:** Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Pherozeshah Mehta, M.G. Ranade.

B. The Moderate Phase (1885-1905)

- Belief:** In petitions, prayers, and constitutional agitation. They believed the British would grant reforms gradually.
- Dadabhai Naoroji:** Called the "Grand Old Man of India". He gave the "Drain of Wealth" theory in his book *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901).
- Early Demands:** Expansion of Legislative Councils, Indianization of Civil Services, and reduction of military expenditure.

C. The Extremist Phase (1905-1919)

- Reason:** The failure of Moderate methods. The Partition of Bengal (1905) by Lord Curzon sparked the fire.
- Key Leaders:** Lal-Bal-Pal — Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab Kesari), Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Father of Indian Unrest), Bipin Chandra Pal.
- Swadeshi Movement (1905):** Boycott of all foreign goods, especially British. Promoting Indian goods and industries.
- Tilak's Slogan:** "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it."
- Surat Split (1907):** The INC split into Moderates and Extremists at the Surat Session due to disagreements over methods.

D. The Gandhian Era (1919-1947) — Most Important for SSC

Event	Year	Details
Jallianwala Bagh Massacre	1919	General Dyer fired on a peaceful crowd in Amritsar (Punjab). Killed hundreds. Rabindranath Tagore renounced his knighthood in protest.
Rowlatt Act	1919	Allowed the British to arrest Indians without trial. Gandhiji called for a nationwide Hartal (strike) against it.
Non-Cooperation Movement	1920-22	Launched by Gandhiji after the Khilafat issue. Called for boycotting government institutions, courts, schools, and foreign cloth. Chauri Chaura incident (1922) – police station burnt, 22 policemen killed. Gandhiji called off the movement abruptly.
Simon Commission	1928	All-British commission to review the Government of India Act. All Indians opposed it. Lala Lajpat Rai was lathi-charged during a protest and later died.
Dandi March / Salt Satyagraha	1930	Gandhiji marched from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi (240 miles) and broke the salt law. Started the Civil Disobedience Movement.
First Round Table Conference	1930	Boycotted by INC.
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	1931	Gandhiji agreed to suspend Civil Disobedience. British agreed to release political prisoners.
Second Round Table Conference	1931	Gandhiji attended but no consensus was reached.
Government of India Act, 1935	—	Provided for a federal structure and provincial autonomy. Introduced direct elections.
Quit India Movement	1942	Launched with the slogan “Do or Die”. All INC leaders were arrested immediately. It was a mass uprising.
Subhash Chandra Bose	—	Formed the Indian National Army (INA) / Azad Hind Fauj in 1943. Gave slogan: “Tum Mujhe Khoon Do, Main Tumhe Aazadi Dunga” (You give me blood, I will give you freedom).
Cabinet Mission Plan	1946	Proposed a united India with a loose federal structure. Rejected by Muslim League.
Mountbatten Plan	June 1947	Announced the partition of India into two dominions – India and Pakistan.
Independence	August 15, 1947	India became independent. Lord Mountbatten became the first Governor-General of independent India.

6. Important Personalities, Nicknames & Books (High-Yield for SSC)

Personality	Nickname / Title	Famous Book / Slogan
Dadabhai Naoroji	Grand Old Man of India	Poverty and Un-British Rule in India
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Father of Indian Unrest / Lokmanya	Gita Rahasya; Slogan: "Swaraj is my birthright"
Lala Lajpat Rai	Punjab Kesari	Unhappy India
Gopal Krishna Gokhale	Social Reformer / Political Guru of Gandhi	—
Subhash Chandra Bose	Netaji	Indian Struggle; Slogan: "Tum Mujhe Khoon Do"
Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel	Iron Man of India	Integrated 562 princely states into India.
Jawaharlal Nehru	Architect of Modern India	Discovery of India, Glimpses of World History
Bhagat Singh	Shaheed-e-Azam	Why I am an Atheist
Rabindranath Tagore	Gurudev / Bard of Bengal	Gitanjali (Nobel Prize, 1913)
Swami Vivekananda	Patriotic Saint	Hinduism speech at Chicago (1893)
A.O. Hume	Founder of INC	—
W.C. Bonnerjee	First President of INC	—

7. Important Years Chronology (Quick Revision)

Year	Event
1498	Vasco da Gama reaches Calicut
1600	East India Company formed
1757	Battle of Plassey
1764	Battle of Buxar
1765	Treaty of Allahabad (Diwani granted)
1857	Revolt of 1857
1858	Queen's Proclamation / Government of India Act
1885	INC founded
1905	Partition of Bengal / Swadeshi Movement
1907	Surat Split
1919	Jallianwala Bagh Massacre / Rowlatt Act
1920-22	Non-Cooperation Movement
1930	Dandi March / Civil Disobedience Movement
1942	Quit India Movement
1947	Independence of India

Final Pro-Tip for GA:

- Do not read long paragraphs. Focus on bullet points — who, what, when, where, why.
- Make a flashcard set of all important dates and personalities. Revise them daily for 15 minutes.
- In the exam, if you don't know the answer, eliminate obviously wrong options using logic (e.g., if the question is about Gandhiji, options from 1885 or 1947 are likely wrong).